

Chinese Student Association Constitution

Article I. Name

This organization shall be called the Chinese Student Association of Furman University.

Article II. Purpose

Sections I. To build a prosperous community that will consist of not only Chinese students and scholars (assistants, teachers, and advisors who come from China and exchange in Furman for semesters, or scholars interested in FU-CSA), but also those with other ethnic backgrounds who have an interest in Chinese tradition and culture.

Section II. To promote the cultural exchange between Chinese culture and other cultures, as well as to promote the cultural diversity of the Furman community.

Section III. To celebrate Chinese culture through various festivals, charity, and social events throughout the year by organizing entertaining activities.

Section IV. To help students who are interested in learning Chinese language, Chinese history and customs.

Section V. To help newly arrived Chinese students and scholars adapt to Furman and Greenville community.

Article III. Membership

Section I. Definition

Furman University Chinese Student Association (FU-CSA) is an organization that consists of all the Chinese students and scholars as well as students who are interested in China from other ethnic backgrounds in Furman University.

Section II. All the international Chinese students and scholars shall be considered as members of FU-CSA.

Section III. FU-CSA membership is open to all Furman University members.

Section IV. Membership Year

A. International Chinese Students and scholars and newly arrived Chinese are automatically included as members of FU-CSA until request to cancel the membership.

B. Students from other ethnic backgrounds have to renew their membership every

year in order to be a member of FU-CSA.

C. Membership Year starts from August 18th to the following year May 1st.

Section V. Voting membership

Every member in FU-CSA has the right to vote in decision-making. President votes only in case of a tie.

Article IV. Members and Faculty Member

Section I.

Advisor: Dr. Dongming Zhang --- Associate Professor of Asian Studies

Section II.

Executive Members:

- President: Melina George
- Vice President: Luca Breslin
- Treasurer: Alex Liang
- Social Media Manager(s): Ella Back & Rachel Sun

Other members' information can be found on FUCSA or SyncDIN

Article IV. Meetings

Section I. Meetings

- A.** Chinese Student Association shall hold meetings once every two weeks at 8:30pm unless otherwise decided by the association.
- B.** The president may call special meetings.
- C.** A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of the voting membership.

Article V. Elections and officers

Section I.

Officers

Officers of Chinese Student Association will consist of: president, vice-president, director of activities, director of public affairs, secretary and treasurer.

A. The President of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Faithfully execute all provisions of the Constitution.
- 2) Establish meeting times and preside over all meetings of the association.
- 3) Vote as a member only in the case of a tie.
- 4) Oversee all constitutionally prescribed elections.
- 5) Have knowledge and take care of the whole association.

B. The Vice President of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Faithfully execute all provisions of the Constitution.
- 2) Official Representative of CSA
- 3) Oversight all club affairs
- 4) Concern about all CSA activities.
- 5) Have the right to make decision for CSA besides the president
- 6) Take up any role that is not being fulfilled

C. The Director of Creativities of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Prepare and organize intramural games of Furman University.
- 2) Come up with ideas and organize various events.

D. The Director of Public Affairs of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Official speaker of FU-CSA besides the President.
- 2) Promote FU-CSA events by sending out message cross members and other organizations.
- 3) Maintain and improve FU-CSA's relationship with the external organizations.
- 4) Improve the public profile of FU-CSA.

E. The Director of Public Relations of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Assist Director Public Affairs in promoting profile of CSA.

F. The Director of Recreation of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Convey and suggest creative ideas about different events.
- 2) Organize and coordinate issues related to CSA events and meetings.

G. The Director of Advertisement of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Design FU-CSA materials that would use to advertise.
- 2) Improve FU-CSA's images through various designs.
- 3) Establish the website of FU-CSA.

H. The Director of Academics of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Assist members' academic issues, improving both efficiency and quality of academic study.
- 2) Hold seminars, inviting professionals to give presentation regarding different topics.
- 3) Enhance internal academic communication of FU-CSA.
- 4) Assist members in exploring their interests and hobbies.

I. The Secretary of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Official host of meeting besides the President.
- 2) Assist president in dealing with various problems.
- 3) Have knowledge and care about the whole FU-CSA.
- 4) Record the minutes and important notes of meetings.

J. The Treasurer of Chinese Student Association shall:

- 1) Organize and oversee all aspects of financial requirement and internal financial control of FU-CSA.
- 2) Create an operate budget, monitoring financial activity of the FU-CSA, report all the financial statement to the association.
- 3) Has sign authority.
- 4) Lead in develop raising fund proposal and participate in it.

Section II. Election of Officers

President of Chinese Student Association will be elected from previous Executive Board members only. Other officer positions are open to all membership. Officers will be nominated by active members of FU-CSA according to their capabilities and attendance or by themselves. Voting in the election shall be done by secret ballot with a majority needed to win. Nominees must win by

plurality. In the event of a tie, President shall cast the deciding vote.

Section III. Recall of Office

Any officers will be removed from leadership upon failure to:

- A. Fulfill his/her duties.
- B. Attend three meetings without prior approval from the president or the general secretary.
- C. Assist with the event preparation twice without approval from the president or the general secretary.
- D. Communicate properly to the rest of the organization or intentionally make it difficult to communicate (including the need to be contacted through another individual)

Section IV. Term in office

Any executive position can be held for multiple terms without any preset limit.

Section V. In the instance of temporary vacancy of the President:

- A. The sitting president will assign a temporary stand-in for presidency who will NOT have the same executive powers as the sitting president
 - a) Such limitations on the stand-in president are as follows:
 - i. They do not possess the ability to alter the constitution without formal consent of the advisor
 - ii. They will not have access to the Chinese Student Association's Instagram account
 - iii. They cannot vote in the instance of a tie and must contact the sitting president
- B. If the sitting president does not assign a temporary stand-in, the status of stand-in president will pass onto the Vice President. If the Vice President is also gone, the Treasurer will inherit the stand-in role. If neither position is filled then CSA will cease all operations until these positions are assigned by the sitting president

Article V. Mergers and Acquisitions

For a merger and acquisition to occur surrounding the organization, all conditions must be met:

- A. Approval of said merger by the advisors of both standing organizations
- B. Approval of all executive members of the Chinese Student Association
- C. Majority vote by the Asian Studies Department

- D.** Agreement that the organization name of the “Chinese Student Association” will not be altered after the merger/acquisition

Article VI. Member responsibilities

Section I. Each member of Chinese Student Association shall:

- A.** Strive to present in every meeting.
- B.** Actively participate in every activities held by the association.
- C.** Respect every other member in the association.

Article VII. Programming/Event Planning

- A.** The Chinese Student Association is dedicated to furthering the inclusive community on Furman University’s campus. Therefore, all programs/events associated with the CSA will follow such guidelines:
 - a)** All events hosted or co-hosted by CSA must involve Chinese culture/tradition, unless CSA wishes to represent an underrepresented Asian group on campus
 - b)** There will be no affiliation with any politics-driven organization for the sake of staying neutral on Furman’s campus
 - i.** This includes the signing of any petition unless the petition specifically involves the wellbeing of Chinese students
 - ii.** Regardless of the intentions of the co-hosting organization, the co-host must not have a reputation of supporting a polarizing cause

Article VIII. Constitutional Amendment

Section I. Amendments to the Constitution

- A.** This constitution may be amended by a majority vote of the Chinese Student Association.
- B.** Any proposed amendment must be presented to the president and general secretary in writing one meeting prior to the vote on the amendment.